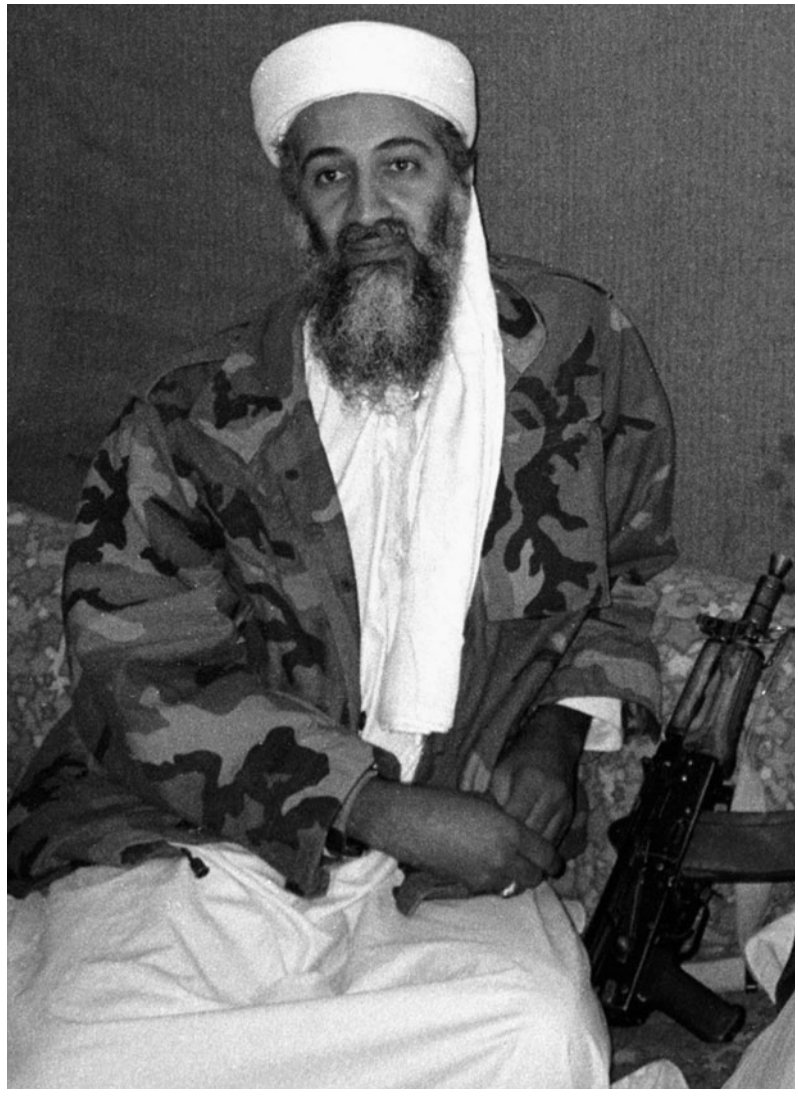
Key term

'Right to return' The right of Palestinian refugees and their descendants to return to their pre-1948 homes in Israel and the occupied territories.

the **'right to return'** to their homeland for millions of Palestinian living in refugee camps. Worst of all, for the Palestinians, the Israelis continued to build Jewish settlements on Arab land on the West Bank (see page 100). In 1998, Bin Laden and al-Zawahari called on Muslims 'to fulfil their duty to kill Americans and their allies in order to liberate the al-Aqsa mosque in Jerusalem and the Holy Mosque [in Mecca] from their grip'. They listed three reasons for their jihad:

- the presence of US military bases in the Arabian peninsular
- the 'destruction' of Iraq by the USA (through the continuing use of sanctions)
- US backing for 'the petty state of the Jews' (i.e. Israel).

The Americans countered by saying that their military presence in Saudi Arabia and the Gulf states was to protect those states from threats posed by Iran and Iraq. However, film footage, on



Osama Bin Laden. He was widely respected in the Arab world for having given up a life of wealth and comfort for one of hardship and danger. He was (and still is) seen by many as a Middle Eastern Robin Hood, defending the poor and vulnerable against a distant tyrant.